# Composition Pair B1.19 + B1.20 — The Reinforcing Pair Where Cross-Level Access Provides the Operational Channels Through Which Recursive Governance Reaches Entities at Each Structural Level, and Recursive Governance Provides the Authority Framework That Makes Cross-Level Access Governed Rather Than Technically Arbitrary

**Author:** Wenxin Li (Independent Researcher)

**ORCID:** 0009-0004-8065-3235

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## Attribution

*This work derives from and formalizes the instinct/reasoning separation pattern introduced in "The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model" (Li, April 2026), the second paper in the CKS theory series following "Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems" (Li, April 2026). It does not introduce new axioms. Its contribution is to formalize the composition relationship between two foundational Paper 2 commitments — cross-level access (B1.19) and recursive governance (B1.20) — as a reinforcing pair in which each concept provides what the other requires to function.*

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## Abstract

Paper 2 commits to two architectural properties that together govern how a CKS-structured Self maintains coherent governance across its three structural levels: cross-level access (B1.19), the governed mechanism by which entities at one level interact with entities at other levels through access rules, authority distribution, and event recording; and recursive governance (B1.20), the commitment that Paper 1's governance properties apply independently at cell, aspect, and Self scope rather than only at deployment scope. This note formalizes the composition relationship between these two commitments as a reinforcing pair. B1.19 enables B1.20 to operate in practice: recursive governance requires channels through which higher-level governance authority reaches lower-level entities and through which lower-level operational evidence reaches higher-level governance; B1.19's governed access channels are those channels. B1.20 provides the authority framework that makes B1.19's access governed rather than technically arbitrary: without recursive authority architecture specifying who holds governance authority at each level scope, cross-level access is authorized at deployment scope but not at entity scope, and the architecture cannot distinguish legitimate level-appropriate access from access that happens to be technically possible. Each commitment requires the other to deliver its architectural function; neither is fully operative without its pair partner. The note traces the enabling direction, the authority direction, their mutual reinforcement, the co-presence requirement, their operational integration, detection procedures, and the two failure modes that correspond to pair-partial states.

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## 1. Pair Identification

**Concept A: B1.19 — Cross-level access.**

The governed mechanism by which entities at one structural level interact with entities at other levels, specified through access rules determining which entities have access authority in which direction, authority distribution per A2.47 configuring who holds that authority, and event recording per A2.40 creating a traceable log of cross-level interactions. Cross-level access is not technically unrestricted inter-level communication; it is inter-level interaction that is governed — subject to the same architectural properties Paper 1 defends at the cell level, extended to cover the inter-level perimeter.

**Concept B: B1.20 — Recursive governance.**

The commitment that Paper 1's governance properties — human-governed (A1.01), path retraceability (A1.07), authority architecture (A2.47), and the full set of governance affordances (A2.01–A2.04) — apply at cell scope, at aspect scope, and at Self scope independently, rather than only at deployment scope or only at the cell level. Recursive governance means each entity at each level is independently governed: cells hold cell-scope governance, aspects hold aspect-scope governance, and the Self holds Self-scope governance, with each level's governance framework derived from the same Paper 1 commitments rather than invented fresh at each level.

**Relationship type: Reinforcing pair.**

B1.19 provides the operational infrastructure through which B1.20's recursive governance affordances are exercised across levels. B1.20 provides the authority framework that makes B1.19's cross-level access architecturally governed rather than technically arbitrary. The two commitments require each other: B1.20 without B1.19 produces governance rights that cannot be exercised cross-level; B1.19 without B1.20 produces access channels that lack the level-appropriate authority framework governance requires.

## 2. Enabling Direction: B1.19 Enables B1.20 to Operate Across Levels

Recursive governance per B1.20 specifies that Paper 1's commitments apply at each structural level. But specifying that each level is governed does not by itself create the means for higher-level governance to act on lower-level entities, or for lower-level operational evidence to reach higher-level governance for review. Those means require governed access channels — precisely what B1.19 provides.

**Downward channels.**

Self-scope governance per B2.102 applies Paper 1's governance commitments at Self scope. When that governance needs to exercise affordances on lower-level entities — inspecting cell substrates (A2.01 at cell scope per B2.107), modifying cell DNA (A2.02 at cell scope), or coordinating aspects across cells — it must reach those entities through a governed channel. B1.19 provides that channel: B2.96 pattern 1 specifies Self governance over aspects through cross-level access; B2.96 pattern 2 specifies aspect coordination over cells. Without B1.19, Self-scope governance cannot reach cells through a governed channel. The governance authority exists per B1.20, but it cannot be exercised on the entities that require it. Governance affordances become rights without infrastructure.

The same applies at the aspect-to-cell perimeter. Aspect-scope governance per B2.103 applies Paper 1's commitments at aspect scope, which includes the authority to inspect and coordinate across the cells the aspect governs. Exercising that authority on specific cells requires cross-level access per B1.19 — not unstructured direct access, but access through governed channels with authority configured by the recursive governance framework B1.20 establishes.

**Upward channels.**

Recursive governance per B1.20 includes path retraceability (A1.07) applied recursively — per B2.105, this means cell-level operational evidence contributes to aspect-level and Self-level retraceability, not only to cell-level records. For cell-level evidence to reach aspect and Self governance, it must travel through governed upward access channels per B2.96 pattern 5 (operational reporting). Without B1.19, cell-level evidence cannot reach higher-level governance through a governed path. The retraceability commitment exists at each level per B1.20, but the governed path that connects level-specific records into a coherent cross-level retraceable history depends on B1.19's upward channels.

The enabling direction is therefore bidirectional: B1.19 provides both the downward channels through which recursive governance authority reaches lower-level entities, and the upward channels through which lower-level operational evidence reaches higher-level governance for review and accountability.

## 3. Authority Direction: B1.20 Provides the Governance Framework That Makes B1.19 Access Governed

Cross-level access per B1.19 requires authority configuration: access rules specify who has access authority in which direction and at which scope, distributed per A2.47. But A2.47's authority distribution must be anchored in some governance architecture to be meaningful — the authority configuration cannot simply declare access rights without specifying what governance framework those rights derive from.

B1.20 provides that framework. Per B2.107, the recursive governance architecture specifies governance affordances at each level scope — who holds A2.01–A2.04 authority at cell scope, at aspect scope, and at Self scope. B2.95's cross-level access authority is distributed per A2.47 within this recursive governance framework: who has cross-level access authority for governance purposes is determined by who holds the relevant governance affordances at the accessing level's scope.

Without B1.20, cross-level access authority is specified at deployment scope only. A deployment-level authority holder has access authority, but the recursive governance framework that distinguishes Self-scope access authority from aspect-scope access authority from cell-scope access authority does not exist. The result is that any entity holding deployment-level authority can access any entity at any level, because there is no level-appropriate authority specification to restrict or channel that access differently at different scopes. Cross-level access is technically governed — access rules exist, events are recorded — but the authority those rules operationalize is deployment-uniform rather than level-appropriate.

B1.20's recursive authority architecture is what makes the "governed" in "governed cross-level access" architecturally meaningful at each level. The distinction between Self-scope governance authority acting downward on cells through legitimate channels and an arbitrary deployment-level principal accessing cells through technically-permitted-but-not-level-appropriate channels depends on the recursive authority framework B1.20 establishes.

## 4. Mutual Reinforcement

**B1.19 provides B1.20's operational infrastructure.**

The governance affordances B1.20 specifies at each level — inspect at cell scope, modify at aspect scope, override at Self scope — are rights that must be exercisable in practice. Exercising these affordances on entities at other levels requires access to those entities through governed channels. B1.19's governed channels are the operational infrastructure that makes B1.20's affordances exercisable cross-level. The A2.02 modify affordance at cell scope per B2.107 requires access to cell DNA per B2.95's access rules; the A2.01 inspect affordance at cell scope requires access to cell substrate content. Without B1.19's governed channels, B1.20's recursive governance affordances exist as rights but cannot be exercised cross-level. They are real architectural commitments that cannot be operationalized across the level boundary.

**B1.20 provides B1.19's governance legitimacy.**

Cross-level access per B1.19 is governed through authority distribution per A2.47 and event recording per A2.40. But recording an access event does not by itself establish that the access was level-appropriate — it establishes that the access was authorized at some scope. B1.20's recursive authority architecture provides the framework within which access authority is determined to be level-appropriate: who has A2.01–A2.04 authority at a given level scope determines who has cross-level access authority for governance purposes at that scope. B1.19 access authority, in a system where B1.20 is operative, derives from B1.20's recursive authority architecture rather than from deployment-level permission alone. This derivation is what gives cross-level access its governance legitimacy — it is not merely technically permitted, it is authorized within the level-appropriate governance framework.

## 5. Co-Presence Requirement

**B1.19 without B1.20 — cross-level access without recursive governance.**

Cross-level access channels exist and events are recorded, but the governance authority framework is specified at deployment scope only. Any deployment-level authority holder can access any entity at any level; there is no level-appropriate authority architecture to determine whether Self-scope access authority is being exercised by an entity that holds it at Self scope. This is the Deployment-Level-Only Governance anti-pattern (B3.21): governance affordances exist at deployment scope but not at entity scope, and the level boundary provides no governance protection because no level-appropriate authority framework exists to protect it. Cross-level access is technically governed but not level-appropriately governed.

**B1.20 without B1.19 — recursive governance without cross-level access channels.**

Paper 1 commitments apply at each level scope in principle, and governance affordances are specified at cell, aspect, and Self scope. But higher-level governance cannot reach lower-level entities through governed channels, and lower-level operational evidence cannot reach higher-level governance through governed paths. The Self holds Self-scope governance affordances but must use unstructured direct access to exercise them on cells. Aspects cannot conduct governed coordination over cells. The level-specific governance frameworks are independently specified but architecturally isolated — each level is governed independently, but the governed cross-level interaction that makes a three-level architecture coherent is absent. This is the Ungoverned Cross-Level Access anti-pattern (B3.20): level-appropriate governance exists at each level, but the channels connecting levels are not governed.

**Full co-presence.**

When both B1.19 and B1.20 are present and correctly configured, governed cross-level access channels carry recursive governance affordances from higher to lower levels and carry operational evidence from lower to higher levels. Level-appropriate authority per B1.20's recursive architecture governs who accesses what per B1.19's access rules. The three-level architecture is governed coherently throughout — not only at each level independently, but across the level boundaries that connect them.

## 6. Operational Integration

Recursive governance per B1.20 specifies governance affordances at each level. B2.95's cross-level access rules configure which entities have access authority across which level boundaries, and that configuration derives from B1.20's recursive authority architecture per B2.107 rather than from deployment-level permission alone. Governance reviews conducted at Self scope exercise A2.01–A2.04 at Self scope directly — over Self-level substrate content — and at aspect and cell scope through B1.19's governed downward access channels. The Self-scope governance principal does not need unstructured access to cells; governed downward channels make cell-scope governance affordances available at the correct authority scope.

Action-feedback evidence per B1.15's multi-shaped governance architecture reaches aspect and Self governance through B1.19's upward access channels. Cell-level operational results, conflict records, and retraceability entries per A1.07 at cell scope contribute to aspect-level and Self-level retraceability through governed upward reporting paths. The recursive retraceability commitment per B2.105 is operationally realized through B1.19's upward channels.

Recursive commitments verification per B2.110 — the process of verifying that Paper 1's commitments hold at each level — requires reaching all entities at all levels through governed channels. The verification process must be able to inspect cell substrates from Self scope, confirm aspect-level governance configuration, and verify that the access authority configuration derives from the recursive authority architecture rather than from deployment-level-only permission. B1.19 provides those channels for the verification process itself.

## 7. Detection

The pair's operative state can be evaluated through two verification procedures and one completeness check.

**B2.97 cross-level access verification.**

Are cross-level access channels configured and is authority correctly distributed? The verification asks: do access rules specify which entities have access authority in which direction and at which scope? Is the authority distribution traceable to A2.47? Are cross-level access events recorded per A2.40? A system where access channels exist but authority distribution is absent or deployment-uniform fails this check regardless of whether access appears to function.

**B2.110 recursive commitments verification.**

Can verification reach all entities at all levels through governed channels? The verification asks: can governance affordances be exercised at cell scope from Self scope through governed channels? Can cell-level operational evidence be retrieved from higher-level governance scope through governed upward paths? A system where cross-level access channels technically exist but are not governed per B1.19 fails this check even if recursive governance commitments are specified per B1.20.

**Pair completeness check.**

Does the access authority configuration in B2.95 derive from the recursive authority architecture per B2.107, rather than from deployment-level-only authority? If cross-level access authority is specified uniformly at deployment scope — the same authority configuration regardless of which level is accessing which — the pair is operating in the B3.21 partial state even if access channels exist. The completeness check is whether the level-appropriate authority framework B1.20 establishes is reflected in the access authority configuration B1.19 operationalizes.

## 8. Failure Modes

**B3.21 — Deployment-Level-Only Governance (B1.20 absent).**

When recursive governance is not present, the governance authority framework covers only the deployment level. Cross-level access channels may exist and events may be recorded, but the authority those channels operationalize is not level-appropriate. Any deployment-level authority holder can access any entity at any level through technically-permitted channels. The three-level architecture loses its level-boundary governance integrity: cells are accessible from Self scope not because Self-scope governance authority has been correctly configured but because deployment-level permission does not distinguish access levels. B3.21 is a partial-pair failure: the channel infrastructure of B1.19 is present but the authority framework of B1.20 that gives those channels their governance character is absent.

**B3.20 — Ungoverned Cross-Level Access (B1.19 absent).**

When cross-level access channels are not governed, recursive governance exists at each level in principle but the levels are architecturally isolated from each other for governance purposes. Self-scope governance affordances cannot be exercised on cells through governed channels; they can only be exercised through unstructured direct access that bypasses the governed-channel requirement. Aspect-scope governance cannot conduct governed coordination over cells. Cell-level operational evidence cannot reach higher-level governance through governed paths. B3.20 is a partial-pair failure: the level-appropriate authority framework of B1.20 is present but the channel infrastructure of B1.19 that connects levels through governed access is absent.

**Complete pair failure.**

When both B1.19 and B1.20 are absent, the three-level architecture has neither governed inter-level channels nor level-appropriate authority specification. Cross-level access, if it occurs at all, is technically unrestricted — unstructured direct access subject only to whatever technical permissions the deployment imposes, with no governance framework and no governed channels. The enterprise-brain Self's architectural coherence, which depends on governed inter-level coordination at each level scope, is unavailable.

## 9. Conclusion

Cross-level access and recursive governance are not independently deployable architectural properties that happen to coexist in a three-level CKS architecture. They are a reinforcing pair in which each provides what the other requires to function architecturally. B1.19's governed channels are the operational infrastructure through which B1.20's recursive governance affordances are exercised across levels — without those channels, recursive governance rights exist but cannot be operationalized cross-level. B1.20's recursive authority architecture is the framework that makes B1.19's access channels governed rather than technically arbitrary — without that framework, cross-level access channels exist but operationalize deployment-level-uniform authority rather than level-appropriate governance authority.

The pair's co-presence requirement is not a configuration preference; it is an architectural necessity. A system with both B1.19 and B1.20 correctly configured has a three-level architecture that is governed coherently across level boundaries, not only at each level in isolation. A system with either commitment partial or absent operates in a failure mode with a characteristic governance deficit: either the level boundaries provide no governance protection (B3.21), or the governance framework cannot reach across level boundaries to operate (B3.20). Neither partial state delivers the architectural property the enterprise-brain Self requires.

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## Source papers


Li, W. (2026). *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model: Extending the Coordination Knowledge Substrate Pattern to AI Selves under Human Governance.* April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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